

DINO DUEL

VELOCIRAPTOR AND PROTOCERATOPS

Discovering two dinosaur fossils in the same rock is rare enough, but finding a fossil of two dinosaurs locked in combat is even more astounding. This one-in-a-million find shows a *Velociraptor* with its clawed foot lodged in a *Protoceratops*'s throat, while the *Protoceratops* crushes the *Velociraptor*'s arm in its beak. It was discovered by a Polish-Mongolian team of paleontologists in the early 1970s. Scientists think that this fossil may be evidence of the *Velociraptor* hunting the herbivore, or it may simply have chanced upon *Protoceratops* and startled it. Either way, both have been frozen in time for more than 71 million years.

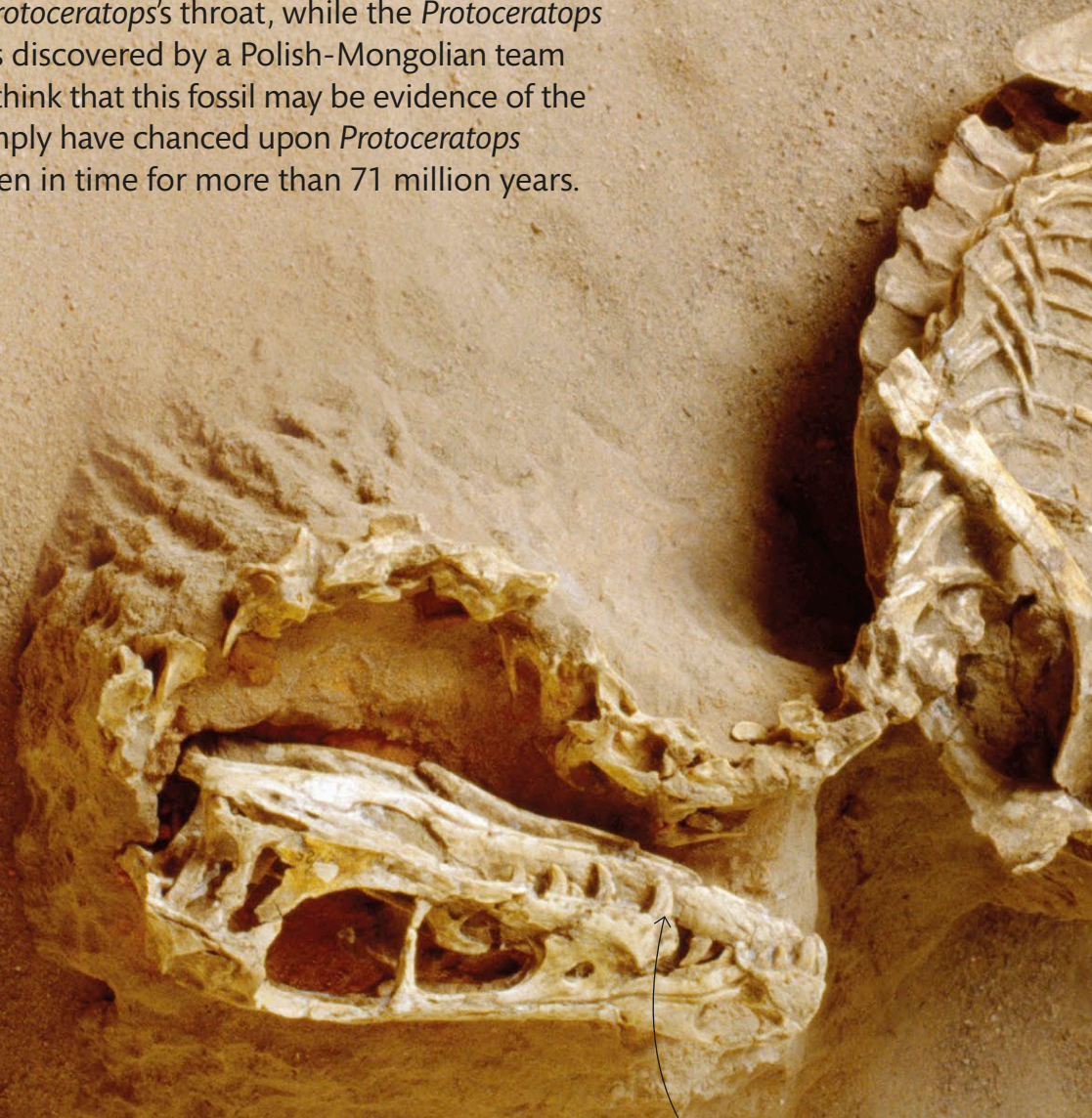
AT A GLANCE

- **YEAR OF DISCOVERY** 1971
- **PLACE** Gobi Desert, Mongolia
- **FOUND BY** Halszka Osmolska and team
- **LIVED** 75-71 MYA



VELOCIRAPTOR

Velociraptor was a small theropod that inhabited the arid deserts of a region now in Mongolia. The arm fossils of a *Velociraptor* specimen show attachment sites for ligaments that may have held long feathers in place.



Serrated teeth